

Problem 6: Altai-ed up

Here are some sentences in English and their corresponding Altaian⁵ translations⁶:

мен кече ол атды сарайда тапганм.	I found that horse in the barn yesterday.
мен сенди айылда сақдым.	I waited for you at home.
бис өлөңде ойнодыыс.	We played on the lawn.
ол кече бу самарады алган.	He/she received this letter yesterday.
олор кече кыр барган.	They went to a mountain yesterday.
бис кече ўредичи школыпда сактаныс.	We waited for a teacher in school yesterday.
сен кече жүсгенн.	You swam yesterday.
ўредичи самара бичди.	The teacher wrote a letter.
эне кече бу бичикди кычырган.	The mother read this book yesterday.
уул көлди барды.	The boy went to the lake.
сен малды азырадын.	You fed the cattle.
бала самара турада тапды.	The child found a letter in the house.

⁵Altai is a Turkic language, spoken officially in the Altai Republic, Russia.

⁶a, o, y, ы are back/hard vowels and ö, ý, e, и are front/soft vowels. All other characters are consonants. Data has been simplified.

Assignment 1: (8 marks)

Translate the following English sentences to Altai:

- (a) The mother found this book in the school.
- (b) We played on the mountain yesterday.
- (c) The boy fed a horse on the lawn.
- (d) You wrote a letter yesterday.

Assignment 2: (8 marks)

Translate the following Altaian sentences to English:

- (a) ол ол самарады кычырды.
- (b) бала менди сақды.
- (c) олар кече көлде жүсген.
- (d) мен кече школыңды барганм.

Assignment 3: (4 marks)

How are words or parts of words put together to form a valid Altaian sentence? What are their meanings and functions?

– *Aparna Gupte*
